A school planning conversation

BEFORE CHOOSING A DESTINATION

Three questions for your next school-trip planning meeting.

Start with the students and the purpose of the trip.

GIVE THE SHORTLIST A PURPOSE

A place can be interesting and still need a closer look for this group.

- What will students explore?
- What pace can the group manage?
- What do families need to know?

WHAT SHOULD STUDENTS EXPLORE IN PERSON?

Name a question students can investigate through observation.

- History: how does a place remember its past?
- Geography: how does a city manage water?

Plan time to discuss what students notice.

WHAT IS MANAGEABLE FOR THIS GROUP?

Consider age, travel experience and accessibility needs.

- Count transfers and walking time.
- Allow for meals and rest.
- Discuss time away from home.

Review the full day, not only the main visit.

WHAT DO FAMILIES NEED TO UNDERSTAND?

Prepare clear information before asking families to commit.

- Expected cost and what it includes.
- Supervision and communication arrangements.
- What is confirmed and what needs checking.

The planning takeaway

WRITE THE BRIEF BEFORE THE SHORTLIST

A useful brief connects the learning purpose, the needs of the group and the questions families will ask.

Use it as the starting point for comparing destinations.